

The Magical Oranges

One day, a young prince was **wandering** round the kingdom **in disguise**, when he saw an old woman by the roadside selling oranges. Seeing him **tempted**, she gave him three oranges, but warned him, "These are magical oranges. **Peel** them only when you are near water."

The prince agreed, and **pocketed** the oranges. But a little further down the road, he felt hungry. Though there was no water, he took out one of the oranges and peeled it. As he did, a beautiful woman emerged from the fruit. But before he could even look at her properly, she **vanished**. However, the prince ate the juicy delicious orange and continued his journey.

After a while, he peeled another orange though there was no water nearby. Again, a very beautiful girl emerged from the fruit and disappeared.

Now the prince was curious. He kept walking till he reached a lake. He peeled the third orange and this time, the prettiest woman he had ever seen emerged from the fruit and smiled at him. The prince was **enchanted**. He asked the girl if she would marry him. She agreed.



The prince wanted to present his **bride** to his parents in style. So he told her to hide in a **hollowed out** tree trunk while he **fetches** grand clothes and a carriage for her. The girl waited.

An old **witch** saw the girl **crouching** and **approached** her. As the girl told her that she was waiting for the prince, the witch said, "How lucky you are! Come, let me dress your hair while the prince returns."

The witch then **pierced** a magic pin into the girl's hair, turning her into a bird. She then **crept into** the hollow, and waited for the prince.

When he returned, he was surprised at how the girl had changed, but she told him it was because of the heat. The prince took her to his parents, who were also surprised at the bride their son had chosen. However, they accepted her, for the prince had **given his word**.



One day, the prince was in the garden, when he saw a little bird, singing a **mournful** song. He noticed a pin on its head. As he removed the pin, the bird became his pretty orange **maiden** again. She told the amazed prince her **tale**.

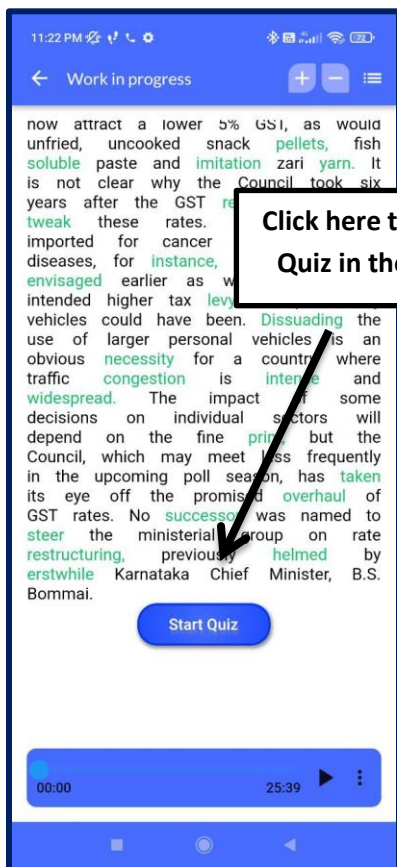
The angry prince then called the guards to take the witch away to prison.

They married and lived happily ever after.

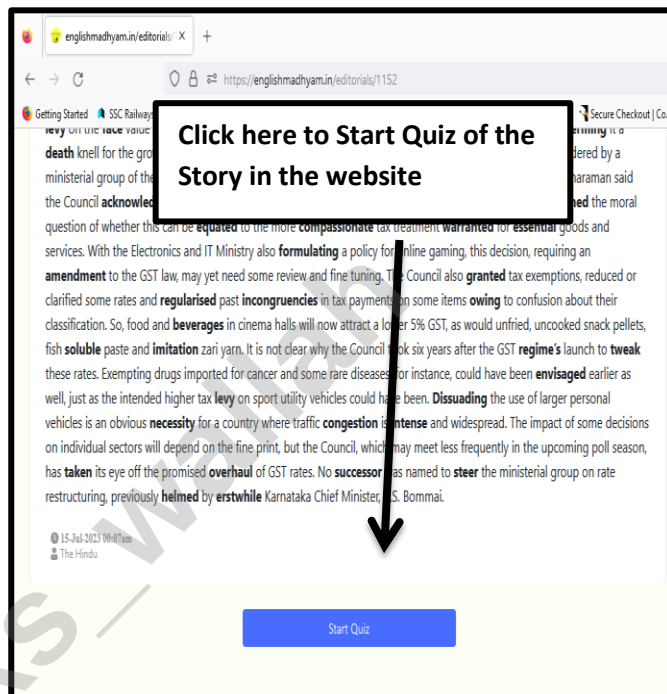
Vocabulary

1. **Wander** (verb) – roam, stroll, meander, drift, saunter – भटकना
2. **In disguise** (phrase) – undercover, incognito, camouflaged, masked, concealed – भेष बदलकर
3. **Tempt** (verb) – entice, lure, attract, seduce, coax – लुभाना / प्रलोभन देना
4. **Peel** (verb) – strip, skin, pare, flay, remove – छीलना
5. **Pocket** (verb) – keep, hide, store, tuck, stow – जेब में रखना
6. **Vanish** (verb) – disappear, fade, evaporate, dissolve, melt away – गायब हो जाना
7. **Enchanted** (adjective) – bewitched, captivated, charmed, fascinated, mesmerized – मोहित / मंत्रमुग्ध
8. **Bride** (noun) – wife-to-be, spouse, newlywed, fiancée, partner – दुल्हन
9. **Hollow out** (phrasal verb) – dig, excavate, scoop, empty, carve out – खोखला करना / गड़ढा करना
10. **Fetch** (verb) – bring, get, retrieve, carry, obtain – लाना
11. **Witch** (noun) – sorceress, enchantress, crone, spellcaster, hag – जादूगरनी
12. **Crouch** (verb) – squat, huddle, bend down, stoop, duck – झुकना / दुबकना
13. **Approach** (verb) – come near, move toward, reach, advance, near – पास आना
14. **Pierce** (verb) – puncture, stab, prick, penetrate, bore – चुभाना / छेद करना
15. **Creep into** (phrasal verb) – enter stealthily, sneak in, slip in, slink in, edge in – चुपके से घुसना
16. **Give one's word** (phrase) – promise, assure, vow, swear, pledge – वचन देना / आश्वासन देना
17. **Mournful** (adjective) – sad, sorrowful, gloomy, melancholic, doleful – शोकाकुल / उदास
18. **Maiden** (noun) – girl, damsel, young woman, lass, virgin – कन्या / युवती
19. **Tale** (noun) – story, narrative, fable, legend, yarn – कहानी / कथा

Practice Exercise



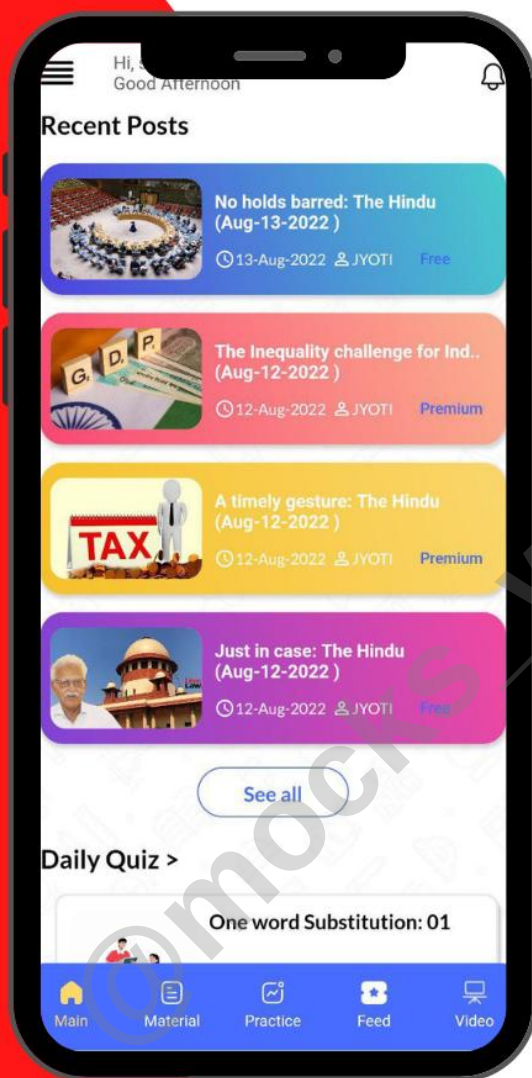
Click here to Start Quiz in the App



Click here to Start Quiz of the Story in the website

[Click here to download App](#)

[Click here to visit website](#)



Learn Vocabulary Through Reading Articles

English Madhyam